



[Home](#) | [API Status](#) | [Historical Data](#) | [Vendor Program](#) | [Developer Forum](#)

Login & Session Management

[Login](#) | [Login Method Summary](#) | [Keep Alive](#) | [Logout](#)

Login

The Betfair API offers three login flows for developers, depending on the use case for your application.

All API requests should be sent as **POST**.

Non-Interactive login

If you are building an application that will run autonomously, there is a separate login flow to follow to ensure your account remains secure.

Interactive login

If you are building an application that will be used interactively, then this is the flow for you. This flow has two variants:

[Interactive login - Desktop Application](#)

This login flow makes use of Betfair's login pages and allows your app to gracefully handle all errors and redirections in the same way as the Betfair website.

[Interactive login - API method](#)

This flow makes use of a JSON API endpoint and is the simplest way to get started if you are looking to create your own login form.

If you're looking for the quickest way to get started, try the [curl example](#) in the Interactive login - API Method.

Login Request Limits



Login Method Summary

Login Type	Use Case	Method	Pros	Cons	Recommendation
Non-interactive Login	Applications running autonomously (e.g., bots).	Non-interactive endpoint with SSL certificate .	Secure for automation. Recommended for bots.	Requires certificate setup.	✅ Use if your app runs without user interaction (e.g., bots, scheduled tasks).
Interactive Login – API Login	Applications needing a simple integration with minimal development time.	API login endpoint (username + password, or username + password + 2FA if enabled).	Easiest to implement. Good for most apps.	Less flexible for handling edge cases compared to the embedded login page.	✅ Use if you want quick setup and don't need T&Cs or jurisdiction workflows.
Interactive Login – Desktop App	Applications used interactively by a wide range of users.	Embedded Betfair login pages .	Handles workflows like T&Cs updates and jurisdiction checks. More flexible for 3rd party apps.	Requires embedding Betfair's login page. More development effort compared to API login.	✅ Use if your app is for many users and must handle extra workflows securely.

Keep Alive

You can use **Keep-Alive** to extend the session timeout period.

- On the international (.com) Exchange the current session expiry time is 12 hours for all customers (excluding UK & Ireland) and 24 hours for UK & Ireland customers.
- The session expiry time is currently 20 minutes on the Italian & Spanish Exchange.
- You should request Keep Alive within this time to prevent session expiry. If you don't call Keep Alive within the specified timeout period, the session will expire.
- Session times aren't determined or extended based on API activity.

Please note: You can configure the timeout via [My Account](#) > **Logout Preferences** if required

Headers

Name	Description	Sample
Accept (mandatory)	Header that signals that the response should be returned as JSON	application/json
X-Authentication (mandatory)	Header that represents the session token that needs to be keep alive	Session Token
X-Application (optional)	Header the Application Key used by the customer to identify the product.	App Key

The presence of the "Accept: application/json" header will signal that the service should respond with JSON and not an HTML page

URL Definition (Global)

```
https://identitysso.betfair.com/api/keepAlive
```

Other Jurisdictions

Please use the below if your country of residence is in one of the list jurisdictions.

Jurisdiction	Endpoint
Australia & New Zealand	https://identitysso.betfair.au/api/keepAlive
Italy	https://identitysso.betfair.it/api/keepAlive

Spain	https://identitysso.betfair.es/api/keepAlive
Romania	https://identitysso.betfair.ro/api/keepAlive

Parameters

The Keep-Alive operation requires no parameters.

Response structure

```
{
  "token": "<token_passed_as_header>",
  "product": "product_passed_as_header",
  "status": "<status>",
  "error": "<error>"
}
```

Status values

SUCCESS
FAIL

Error values

INPUT_VALIDATION_ERROR
INTERNAL_ERROR
NO_SESSION

Call sample

Request

```
curl -k -i -H "Accept: application/json" -H "X-Application: AppKey" -  
H "X-Authentication: <token>" https://identitysso.betfair.com/api/keepAlive
```

Response

```
curl -k -i -H "Accept: application/json" -H "X-Application: AppKey" -
H "X-Authentication: SESSIONTOKEN" https://identitysso.betfair.com/api/keepAlive

{
  "token": "SESSIONTOKEN",
  "product": "AppKey",
  "status": "SUCCESS",
  "error": ""
}
```

Logout

You can use Logout to terminate your existing session.

URL Definition

<https://identitysso.betfair.com/api/logout>

The presence of the "Accept: application/json" header will signal that the service should respond with JSON and not an HTML page

Headers

Name	Description	Sample
Accept (mandatory)	Header that signals that the response should be returned as JSON	application/json
X-Authentication (mandatory)	Header that represents the session token created at login.	Session Token

X-Application (optional)	Header the Application Key used by the customer to identify the product.	App Key
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Response structure

```
{
  "token":"<token_passed_as_header>",
  "product":"product_passed_as_header",
  "status":"<status>",
  "error":"<error>"
}
```

Status values

SUCCESS

FAIL

Error values

INPUT_VALIDATION_ERROR

INTERNAL_ERROR

NO_SESSION

Call sample

```
# full request

curl -k -i -H "Accept: application/json" -H "X-Application: AppKey" -
H "X-Authentication: <token>" https://identitysso.betfair.com/api/logout
```

